

Niron Magnetics

Rare-Earth-Free Permanent Magnets (EV Motor Materials) · Minneapolis, MN · Private (~\$214M raised; reportedly raising ~\$500M at ~\$2-3B, Mar 2026)

Niron Magnetics - the rare-earth-free permanent-magnet leader (Clean Earth Magnet), backed by GM, Stellantis and Volvo and reportedly raising ~\$500M at ~\$2-3B - has never been in motorsport, and the magnet it makes is the heart of the EV motor that Formula E teams build.

75

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Nissan Formula E

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

Niron Magnetics (University-of-Minnesota-born) makes the Clean Earth Magnet - the first powerful permanent magnet built from iron and nitrogen, with no rare-earth elements and so no exposure to China's rare-earth supply chain. Backed by GM Ventures, Stellantis Ventures and Volvo Cars Tech Fund, it has raised ~\$214M, is reportedly raising ~\$500M at a ~\$2-3B valuation (Axios, Mar 2026), and is opening the world's first commercial-scale iron-nitride plant (Sartell, MN; 1,500 t/yr) in 2026. It has never touched motorsport. The FE fit is real: the permanent magnet is the heart of the permanent-magnet synchronous motor FE manufacturers develop in-house, and Niron already integrates its magnets into EV motors (the MATTER variable-flux motor, Jan 2026). The why-now is sharp - China's rare-earth export controls have made magnet-supply independence a board-level priority for every automaker on the grid. Honest framing: adopting Niron in a race motor is a multi-year co-engineering commitment, not an off-the-shelf swap, so the near-term team value is a credible innovation + supply-resilience narrative and an R&D relationship - scored accordingly. Verified decision-maker: CEO Jonathan Rowntree (confirm the commercial/BD lead before outreach).

WHY NOW

China's 2025-26 rare-earth export controls turned magnet-supply independence into a board-level priority for every automaker, and Niron - the only commercial rare-earth-free magnet maker - is scaling fast (first commercial-scale plant online 2026; a reported ~\$500M raise in progress), so brand and partnership investment is live. Formula E, whose manufacturers build permanent-magnet motors, is the most on-message proving stage for that story.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

~\$2-3B

Reported raise in progress (Axios, Mar 2026): ~\$500M round

~\$214M

Total equity raised to date

Clean Earth Magnet

Product: first powerful rare-earth-free permanent magnet (iron + nitrogen)

1,500 tons/yr

World's-first commercial-scale iron-nitride magnet plant (Sartell, MN), online 2026

GM, Stellantis, Volvo

Automotive strategic backers

Jonathan Rowntree

Chief Executive Officer

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Nissan	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Andretti	CROWDED	TWG AI, Quest Global, NAGASE
Porsche	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Jaguar TCS Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

The rare-earth-free permanent-magnet leader: its Clean Earth Magnet (iron-nitride, no rare earths) is the first powerful magnet free of Chinese rare-earth supply chains - and the permanent magnet is the heart of the EV traction motor FE manufacturers build. Backed by GM, Stellantis and Volvo, it is reportedly raising ~\$500M at ~\$2-3B (Mar 2026) and is opening the world's first commercial-scale iron-nitride plant in 2026. A REAL motor-materials workstream with a sharp why-now (China's rare-earth export controls). CEO Jonathan Rowntree.

WHY NISSAN FORMULA E

Nissan is a Japanese EV pioneer that develops its own Formula E powertrain (motor included) and has an open 'EV tech' lane, so a rare-earth-free magnet is a genuinely relevant motor-materials story, not a logo - and magnet-supply independence is a direct strategic concern for a major OEM. No FE team has a magnet or motor-materials partner, so the lane is open for Niron to own.

VALUE TO NISSAN FORMULA E — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A with honest, named mechanics. (1) MOTOR-MATERIALS / TECHNICAL: the permanent magnet is the core of the PM synchronous motor an FE manufacturer develops; Niron's iron-nitride magnet is a credible co-engineering thread for motor efficiency, thermal behaviour and rare-earth-free supply security, and Niron already integrates into EV motors (MATTER) - so the workstream is real, with the honest caveat that race-motor adoption is a multi-year R&D programme. (2) SUPPLY-CHAIN / STRATEGIC: for a global OEM like Nissan, a rare-earth-free magnet partner is a board-level supply-resilience story amid China's export controls - the FE deal is a public proof-point for it. (3) BRAND / CONTENT / TALENT: 'the magnet that frees the electric motor from rare earths, on the all-electric championship' is an ownable co-marketing narrative, a strong independence/sustainability content line, and a recruiting halo for the materials and motor engineers both sides compete for. Nissan gets a distinctive deep-tech motor-materials partner; Niron gets a flagship motorsport reference and access to its exact OEM buyers.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Magnet-Technology / Motor-Materials Partner on the Nissan Formula E Team, minimum three years, ~\$3-5M/yr, with category exclusivity in magnets/motor-materials and a defined rare-earth-free co-engineering and content workstream tied to the motor and the supply-resilience story.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Jonathan Rowntree
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER, NIRON MAGNETICS - VERIFIED

CEO of Niron Magnetics and the owner of brand and strategic-partnership decisions at this scale-up - the right entry point, especially for a deal that doubles as a supply-chain-independence narrative.

Decision path: Rowntree (CEO/strategy) with the commercial/BD lead as counterpart (confirm the named commercial owner before outreach); the OEM-investor relationships (GM/Stellantis/Volvo) are credibility anchors, not the FE route.

OPENING ANGLE

"Jonathan - China's export controls just made rare-earth-free magnets a board-level priority, and the magnet is the heart of the motor Formula E teams build. A partnership with Nissan is the proof-point that takes the Clean Earth Magnet from supply-chain story to the grid. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 16 / 20 Reportedly raising ~\$500M at ~\$2-3B (Axios, Mar 2026) and opening the world's first commercial-scale iron-nitride plant (1,500 t/yr) in 2026 - active capital and a scale-up inflection now.	CAPACITY 15 / 20 ~\$214M raised with GM, Stellantis and Volvo as backers, plus a reported ~\$2-3B round in progress - funds a value-to-mid partner tier comfortably.	BRAND FIT 16 / 20 A rare-earth-free magnet on the all-electric championship is on-message and timely (supply-chain independence is a 2026 board-level theme), and the magnet/motor-materials lane is open across the grid.	URGENCY 13 / 20 China's export controls make magnet-supply independence urgent for every OEM, but there's no dated FE trigger and in-car adoption is a multi-year R&D commitment - real but not pinned to a date.	OPS FIT 15 / 20 MODE A: the permanent magnet is the core of the PM synchronous motor FE manufacturers develop, and Niron already integrates iron-nitride magnets into EV motors (MATTER) - a genuinely deployable motor-materials workstream, albeit a co-engineering programme rather than an off-the-shelf part.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

RACE-MOTOR ADOPTION IS MULTI-YEAR A team putting Niron magnets in its race motor is a co-engineering R&D commitment, not an off-the-shelf swap. **Counter:** Lead with the supply-resilience + innovation narrative and an R&D relationship; score the near-term team value as MODE-A-aspirational, not a guaranteed in-car part - honestly reflected in the score.

SCALE-UP, REPORTED (NOT CLOSED) RAISE The ~\$500M at ~\$2-3B is reported/in-process (Axios, Mar 2026), not a closed round; capacity is value-to-mid. **Counter:** Right-size to a value-to-mid partner tier; ~\$214M already raised plus OEM backers (GM/Stellantis/Volvo) confirm deal-capability now.

OEM BACKERS VS FE MANUFACTURERS Niron's GM/Stellantis/Volvo ties are corporate-VC, not the FE team relationship. **Counter:** Use them as credibility, not as an existing FE deal; the Nissan partnership would be net-new (grid-clean).

SOURCES

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